



# Separation Support

## Premium practice worksheet

### SEPARATION SUPPORT - LESSON 03

## Protect progress by reducing panic rehearsal.

Use this worksheet to create a realistic management plan so the dog is not repeatedly pushed into panic while you work on the training process.

#### TRAINER NOTE

Training goes much better when the dog is not practicing panic between sessions.

#### START HERE

Dog: \_\_\_\_\_

Date: \_\_\_\_\_

Owner: \_\_\_\_\_

Best reward: \_\_\_\_\_

### 1 What success looks like

By the end of this lesson, the owner has a written management plan for workdays, errands, and real-life departures that helps prevent unnecessary distress rehearsal.

### 2 Practice plan

1

#### Map real-life absences

Write down work hours, errands, appointments, and any recurring departure patterns.

2

#### Choose support options

Identify what help is realistic: neighbor, sitter, daycare, family, remote work flexibility, or

3

#### Create a short pre-departure routine

Meet the dog's needs and keep the departure boring and predictable.

4

#### Use management consistently

Follow the plan so training sessions are protected and the dog rehearses less distress.



# Separation Support

## Management Before Training

### 3 Supplies and setup

#### Supplies needed

- ☐ Calendar or weekly planner
- ☐ List of support options such as sitters, daycare, or help from friends
- ☐ Phone reminders
- ☐ Alone-time routine checklist

#### Set up before you start

- ☐ List when the dog is normally left alone during the week.
- ☐ Identify which absences can be changed, shortened, or outsourced.
- ☐ Build management around your real schedule, not an ideal fantasy plan.

### 4 Weekly management planner

| Day | Planned absence | Management support | Dog stayed under threshold? | Adjustments |
|-----|-----------------|--------------------|-----------------------------|-------------|
|     |                 |                    |                             |             |
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### 5 5-day practice micro plan

#### Day 1

##### Set baseline

Find the easiest version and keep it calm.

#### Day 2

##### Repeat wins

Practice the same setup until it looks smooth.

#### Day 3

##### Add one tiny step

Add only one small challenge if yesterday

#### Day 4

##### Hold or simplify

If your puppy struggled, make today easier.

#### Day 5

##### Review notes

Choose the safest next step from your log.



# Separation Support

## Management Before Training

### 6 Common mistakes and quick fixes

#### Common mistakes

- Training hard while still leaving the dog for long unavoidable absences.
- Making a management plan that is unrealistic to maintain.
- Changing the routine every day so nothing feels predictable.
- Treating management like failure instead of part of the treatment plan.

#### If this happens, try this

- If the plan is not sustainable, simplify it and prioritize the highest-risk absences first.
- If support options are limited, start with protecting the longest or hardest departures.
- If your dog seems calmer with one setup, use that consistently while training.

### 7 Ready to progress?

- ☐ I know when my dog is normally left alone.
- ☐ I have at least one realistic support option for difficult absences.
- ☐ My departure routine is simple and repeatable.
- ☐ I have a plan for what to do when training and real life conflict.

#### HOMEWORK

Build a 7-day management plan that covers all expected departures and note which absences still need better support.

### 8 Owner reflection

Biggest win: \_\_\_\_\_

What made it easier: \_\_\_\_\_

What should I repeat tomorrow: \_\_\_\_\_

#### QUESTIONS FOR YOUR FITDOG TRAINER

What should I make easier? \_\_\_\_\_

What should I practice again? \_\_\_\_\_

What is the next realistic step? \_\_\_\_\_